



CRATE IQ: User Interaction & Scenario Guide

The CRATE IQ is designed to be a silent partner. It adheres to the "Less, but Better" philosophy [Designmuseum](#), where the device effectively "disappears" to keep the focus entirely on the record. Below are two scenarios illustrating how different users interact with the device.

Scenario 1: The Sample Hunter (Marcus)

Persona Profile: A hip-hop producer looking for obscure breaks and soulful textures in a dusty basement warehouse

The Interaction

- 1. The Grip:** Marcus pulls the "Stealth Soul" CRATE IQ from his pocket. The smoked matte polycarbonate feels warm and tactile, like a well-worn instrument.
- 2. The Scan:** He finds a generic white-label 12-inch single. Without taking it to a listening station, he holds the device's pinhole camera over the matrix run-out numbers and the small label text. He presses the flush orange button once.
- 3. The Reveal:** The high-contrast Sharp Memory LCD instantly populates with the track's DNA. No "loading" bar, just facts.
 - *Producer:* Organized Noize
 - *Studio:* The Dungeon, Atlanta [Bet](#)
 - *Sample Lineage* Contains a 2-second loop from a 1974 soul record
- 4. The Decision:** Marcus sees that this specific pressing has the "un-quantized" drum takes he's been hunting for. He slides the device back into his pocket. It has served its purpose and vanished.



Scenario 2: The Blind-Buy Specialist (Sarah)

Persona Profile: A high-end jazz collector at an international record fair where listening stations have 30-minute wait times.

The Interaction

- The Approach:** Sarah spots a rare Blue Note pressing with a slightly damaged cover. She can't tell if it's the 1958 original or a later reissue.
- The Scan:** She uses the "Pebble Groove" CRATE IQ. The rounded edges make it easy to hold while she's balancing her record bag. She points the discreet lens at the address printed on the label.
 - Personnel* Lee Morgan, Hank Mobley...
 - Label Fact:* This specific address variant confirms it's a first-pressing "Deep Groove" copy.
- The Data Flow:** She uses the knurled side-dial to scroll through the personnel credits. The Sharp Memory LCD remains perfectly readable under the harsh fluorescent lights of the convention hall. [Youtube](#)
- The Vanishing Act:** Sarah has the information she needs to judge the record "blind." She makes the purchase. The CRATE IQ is back in her bag before the seller even notices she used a device.



Core Interaction Principles

Action	User Experience	Design DNA Influence
Holding	Tactile, warm, premium. Does not feel like a smart phone.	Leica (Tactile), Braun (Neutral)
Scanning	Instant, one-button, no configuration	Playdate (Simple), Teenage Engineering (Playful button)
Reading	High-contrast, sunlight-readable, zero eye-strain.	Sharp Memory LCD / E-ink class. Stackexchange
Exiting	Fast data retrieval followed by immediate pocketing.	"Disappearing" Design Philosophy

Next Steps for User Testing

- Haptic Feedback Calibration:** Define the "click" feel of the scan button to ensure it provides a premium mechanical response. [Mi](#).
- OCR Speed Optimization:** Aim for <1.5 seconds from button press to metadata display to maintain the "instant" feel.
- UI Layout Design:** Finalize a "Credits-First" typography layout that maximizes readability on the 2.7-inch monochrome screen.